FOR SLPS LEAVING CLINICAL WORK

The LinkedIn message that gets ignored, and the one that gets answered.

Same goal. Very different odds.

Swipe →

This one asks a stranger for two hours of work.

GETS IGNORED

You

Hi! I'm a speech pathologist looking to leave the field. I saw you're a Customer Success Manager. Could you tell me what a typical project looks like, how you got the job, what the interview was like, what the salary is, and whether they're hiring? Also, would you look at my résumé?

Why it gets ignored

- ✖ **Six questions.** Answering takes an evening.
- ✖ **No job title.** "Leave the field" gives them nothing to remember you by.
- ✖ **A résumé review.** That's a favor for a friend, not a stranger.
- ✖ **"Are they hiring?"** It reads as a job ask, so it gets treated like one.

This one can be answered from the sofa.

GETS ANSWERED

You

Hi Sam, I'm an SLP in a school district looking at implementation roles, and you made exactly that move. Would you have fifteen minutes in the next couple of weeks? I mostly want to know how you got the first one. No job ask, I promise.

Five things make a message answerable

1. It names **the move they made**.
2. It asks for a **small, fixed amount of time**.
3. It asks for **no job**.
4. It's **easy to decline**.
5. It's **easy to say yes to**: one question, or two time windows.

Too much for a first contact? Send a connection note first.

Connection request

Hi Sam, I'm an SLP looking at implementation roles and saw you made that move from schools. Would love to connect.

Under 200 characters

Its only job is getting a yes. The real message, with your one question, comes after they accept.

SAVE THESE FOR THE LAST TWO MINUTES

> “Is there anyone else you'd talk to if you were me?”

> “If a role opens on your team, would you be open to me sending you the posting?”

The first hands you the next name. The second is a referral ask in its least awkward form.

The full guide covers who to message first, when to follow up, and when to ask for a referral.

How SLPs network into a non-clinical job

Free on slptransitions.com. Link in bio.

Save this for the next message you send.